



AYSO Executive Board Meeting

September 3, 2026@ 7pm PDT

I. Call to Order – 7:03pm PST

- Members in attendance: Patrick Shopbell, Shant Kamanjian, Brandi Lane, Shanti Rao, Luke Powers, Harry Plotkin, Nan Sampath, Ron Johnson, Tona Rodriguez, Matthew Goldman, and Andy Thompson.

II. Discussion Topics

A. Rollout Event Recap

- Overall reception very positive, especially from G12U coaches (reconnecting with past families)
- Key gaps identified:
 - Not enough volunteers for teardown (only 6 people)
 - No way to look up team meeting times or locations at the info tent
 - Some coaches hadn't emailed their teams before the event
- Proposed fixes for next year:
 - Shorten to 9am–12pm (low attendance and extreme heat 12–2pm)
 - Require coaches to email teams by a set deadline before the event
 - Designated meeting areas or sign-up for team meeting times by division
 - Consider reintroducing the team parade/runway introduction format
 - Mandate at least 1 hour attendance for all head coaches
- Uniform pickup: ~90% done by noon, essentially complete by 12:30pm
- Food trucks: lemonade vendor returning for regular season; pie/burger truck didn't meet \$1,500–\$1,600 minimum (region covered the gap)
- Parking complaints consistent with any normal Saturday at Victory Park
- Coach refresher had 30+ at first session; referee refresher well-attended as expected

B. Fall Season: Waitlist and Team Formation

- ~164 kids still on waitlist; 10U has ~38, the largest group
- 10U and 12U waitlist kids being used to fill practice swap requests
 - 22 swap requests in Boys 12U, 19 in Girls 10U
- Team formation deadline was August 8th; 10U ran nearly 2 weeks late
 - Root cause: referee shortage, not coach shortage (had enough coaches by Aug 1)
 - Late formation blocks scheduling entirely since coach conflicts can't be resolved

- Recommendation for next year: set a harder deadline, accept more waitlist kids rather than squeezing in late teams
- Late registrations (mid-August wave) compound the problem every year

C. Referee Points and Sportsmanship

- Referee point minimum set at **14 points** for the season (10-week season)
 - Equivalent to 2 center assignments; everyone gets their AR points regardless
 - Teams below minimum ineligible for playoffs (same as last year)
 - Last year one team scored ~8 points; all others hit at least 13
- Sportsmanship points unchanged from last year:
 - Up to 5 points per week per team; used as top tiebreaker in standings
 - Automatic 1-point deduction for goal differential exceeding 6
 - Teams have been bumped from A to B tournament over this; coaches reminded it's a tiebreaker, not a ban

D. Weather and Air Quality Policy

- New weather page live at aysol3.org/temp; updates every 15 minutes, covers temperature (from Matthew's home station) and air quality (averaged from 5 nearby stations)
- Slack channel alerts Patrick and Matthew when heat index thresholds are hit
- Policy uses CIF wet bulb globe temperature scale (levels 1–5)
 - Level 5: fields must close, no play
 - Level 4: either coach may abandon match without forfeit penalty
 - Coaches and referees always retain authority to abandon for safety, no explanation required
- Air quality thresholds follow EPA guidelines (AQI 150+)
- Region 2 has asked to adopt the policy and share the data; they can reference the public website
- Board confirmed: no forfeit penalty at level 4 or 5

E. Sunday Soccer Lab and Membership-Only Registration

- Albert proposed “Sunday Soccer Lab”: skills/goalkeeper training on Sundays, co-located with Next
 - BPU Academy (similar to Launch Sports) would provide trainers
 - Aimed at U6–U14, split into two time slots; cap ~40 kids per session initially
 - RSVP system needed to manage trainer-to-player ratio
- Likely merges with Jonathan's existing Sunday Skills concept (open scrimmage + workshops for younger kids)
- **Board voted to offer AYSO membership-only registration at \$65** for waitlisted families to participate in Sunday activities
 - Covers national fee (~\$30) plus area/section fees; remainder is effectively a marketing cost
 - Flat fee discourages casual one-off attendance

- Next step: short planning meeting with Jonathan, Albert, and Luke to align timing and format

F. Referee Training and Events

- Referee orientation (all divisions, 6U–14U): **September 8th via Zoom**, ~1 hour, recorded
- Hybrid referee class in Glendale: **September 8th** (online portion + ~4 hours in-person)
- Regional referee class: **September 20th** (all-day)
- Harry and Federico’s youth referee game management class moved to **September 27th** (Sunday) to avoid overlap with the Sept 20 class
 - ~1.5–2 hours; focused on practical game situations for youth refs
- Youth referee “friend takeover” program: youth refs can claim open AR slots to ref games together
 - Matthew will give Harry/Federico access to the scheduling system to manage this
 - Plan to notify 10U coaches at season start
- U6/7/8 referee classes: first two had ~30 each (~27 new refs total); third class Sept 9th with ~14 signed up
- Midseason referee get-together: tentatively **October 8th** at the clubhouse
 - Referee-themed pub trivia, swag (gold whistles, custom water bottles after 5 games), pizza
 - Combined with a post-first-few-weeks refresher session

G. Extra Program, Partnerships, and Events

- Extra (10U competitive): season starts **September 12th**; Matthew scheduling games integrated into regular 10U slots (not always last game of day)
 - All 3 refs for Extra games must be provided by Region 13; center must be intermediate or 2+ years regional experience
 - Extra volunteer coordinators will fulfill their 8 volunteer hours within the core program (red tent, photo day, etc.)
- Region 69 (Palisades) visiting for an Extra game: tentatively **October 10th**
 - Palisades lost all their fields; region wants to do something welcoming
 - Ideas: welcome arch, co-branded pins or shirts (Region 13 / Region 69)
 - Region 13 travels to Palisades in November
- Extra playoff tournament in December: Albert asked if Region 13 can host; pending field availability
- LA Galaxy partnership: 250 tickets + 25 on-field banner experiences distributed; ~300 requested, ~270 fulfilled; official 2026 Youth Partner logo to go on website (Brett)
- Angel City FC: ongoing discussions for ticket blocks and clinics; Harry and Claire attended a Galaxy box event as region reps
- USC soccer team also exploring youth group partnerships

H. Thanksgiving Tournament, Goals, and CPR Training

- **Thanksgiving Tournament (Nov 27–29)**

- Josh taking over as tournament director
 - 64 teams: 16 U10, 32 U12, 16 U14
 - Fields: Victory Park, Marshall, Blair, possibly Butler; Rose Bowl unavailable
 - Updated fees: \$450 (U10), \$550 (U12), \$650 (U14), still below comparable tournaments
 - Goal: fit all U10 and U12 at Victory Park; U14 at satellite fields
 - Target to send invitations around **September 15th** once fields are locked
- **Goals and Fields**
 - Large number of goals stuck in the blockhouse from a tournament 8 months ago; need to move to Country Park
 - Rick Clearing's truck no longer available; plan to rent a U-Haul (~\$35)
 - Must be done within 10 days
 - Blair Upper: lock needs to be sawed off (Ralph); goal there may need replacing with a take-apart goal from blockhouse
 - FIS and Blair Lower nets need replacing; Marshall gets new nets as a courtesy for field use
 - PVC pipe goals at La Cañada fields need to be located and retrieved
 - Jose back in town, field painting underway this week
 - October 24th: Victory Upper unavailable (festival); McKinley added as substitute that day only

CPR/AED Training (new AYSO requirement, effective Jan 1)

- All coaches and assistant coaches must be certified
- Options discussed:
 - Red Cross in-person at clubhouse: 3.5 hours, ~\$140/person
 - American Heart Association hybrid (online + 2-hour in-person elsewhere): ~\$80/person
 - Self-directed with reimbursement (preferred for year 1, given many coaches already need cert for employment)
- Likely approach: offer reimbursement + a dedicated in-person session in **early December** as an option
- All-Star coaches selected by early October; they'll need to complete training before the season
- Suggestion raised to ask Area to include CPR training at the January roadshow
- Youth referees and team managers are exempt from the requirement

III. Next Steps

- **Send dedicated coach email with "Beyond the Ball" workshop flyer**
(Patrick) Workshop on September 8th at the clubhouse; don't wait for the newsletter, send as a standalone flyer to coaches.

- **Organize Silent Saturday for September 26th**Need a volunteer lead: set up sign-making table, brief coaches and referees on enforcement.
- **Confirm picture day grass area permit at Victory Park** - Determine whether the grassy area north of the check-in zone is covered under existing permit or requires a separate rental.
- **Arrange goal moves from blockhouse to Country Park** - Rent a U-Haul; must be completed within 10 days. Also retrieve PVC goals from La Cañada fields.
- **Saw lock off Blair Upper and assess goal situation (Ralph)**Determine if existing white pipe goal stays or needs replacing with a take-apart goal from the blockhouse.
- **Schedule Sunday Soccer Lab planning meeting** - Align Jonathan, Albert, and Luke on timing, field split, and RSVP system before promoting in the newsletter.
- **Give Harry and Federico scheduling system access for youth ref slot management (Matthew)**Enables youth refs to claim open AR spots and ref games together; email 10U coaches at season start to explain.
- **Add LA Galaxy 2026 Youth Partner logo to website (Brett)**Logo asset already on hand; spot exists on site but was turned off.
- **Pin Region 69 Extra game to an optimal mid-morning time slot (Matthew)**Tentatively October 10th; traveling team from Palisades, so avoid early morning. Plan welcome gesture (pins, shirts).
- **Set up CPR/AED training for early December (Dan)**- Offer both a region-hosted Red Cross session and a self-directed reimbursement path; also ask Area about adding it to the January roadshow.
- **Send Extra volunteer coordinator names to Janelle (Patrick)** - Extra families owe 8 volunteer hours to the core program; Janelle coordinates red tent and photo day staffing.

The next meeting is scheduled for October 1, 2026. The meeting was adjourned at 8:47pm PDT.

Respectfully submitted,
Christina Scott